



Rating
Sell

North America
United States

Health Care
Medical Supplies & Devices

Company
Intuitive Surgical

Reuters
ISRG.OQ

Bloomberg
ISRG US

Exchange
NMS

Ticker
ISRG

Date
23 July 2026

Industry Update

Price at 22 Jul 2026 (USD)	340.69
Price Target	324.00
52-week range	592.85 - 340.69

Key takeaways from Society of Robotic Surgery investor summit

Ahead of the SRS scientific sessions that kick off Thursday, today the Society held its annual investor symposium featuring program updates from senior executives of several robotic surgery companies as well as KOL panel discussions spanning an array of hot topics du jour including technology innovation, site of care, AI, and remanufactured instruments. This morning's earlier-than-expected US FDA approval of J&J's Ottava generated considerable buzz, and herein we present key takeaways from panel discussions with leadership of J&J, Intuitive, Medtronic, and Stryker.

We also highlight some interesting findings from a large survey of SRS members (n=451 surgeons across specialties from around the world) that help inform the outlook for robot-assisted surgeries: technology adoption/procedure growth, competitive landscape, and structural trends like continued surgical volume migration to the ASC and expected impact of AI.

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SRS physician survey

- On average, robot-assisted surgery penetration is expected to increase from 33% presently to 48% five years hence on a worldwide basis. This implies a WW robotic surgery procedure CAGR of +~11% over this timeframe and continuing to be driven both by conversion of open to a MIS approach broadly and, within the latter, further shift from conventional lap to robot-assisted surgery.
- In looking at the US survey respondent subgroup, robotic penetration is projected to rise from 64% currently to 69% over this timeframe – thus implying more modest robotic surgery volume growth relative to OUS/WW rates, which of course reflects a more penetrated US market vs internationally. This expected increase in US robotic penetration is expected to come exclusively from conversion of open surgeries as conventional lap usage is projected to remain flattish.
- Notably, given the selection bias of this survey targeting SRS membership (with a median of 17 years of experience as an attending), technology adoption amongst this cohort is obviously higher than the overall market and hence this growth rate surely understates the overall market outlook. Indeed, the consensus view of all the companies remains that the overall soft-tissue robotic surgery global TAM is still <10% penetrated.
- Regarding competitive landscape, on a worldwide basis, Intuitive's da Vinci currently holds an 81% installed base share, which is forecasted to

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decline to 68% over the next five years, at which point Medtronic is expected to be the #2 player with Hugo garnering 10% terminal share amongst survey respondents.

- In the US, da Vinci's installed base share currently stands at 98% and likewise is expected to decline in the years ahead – though expectations for Intuitive to maintain a still-dominant 84% share five years hence is notable in light of market entry of several competitors including Medtronic and J&J, who are entering this market with the advantage of a longstanding strong presence in surgical devices. One caveat here is that the survey was conducted in March, and given the rapid developments in this category (case in point being today's FDA approval of Ottava), share dynamics will continue to be fluid – but the clear takeaway is that da Vinci remains well-positioned for clear and sustained category leadership.
- Regarding site of care, survey data project that roughly one-third of all addressable surgeries will be done in the ASC setting five years hence. For frame of reference, we believe Intuitive's mix of procedures and installed base currently stands in the ~MSD range.
- In terms of AI, survey data clearly portend a significant impact on various aspects of robotic surgery, with intra-operative anatomic intelligence and pre-operative planning expected to be among the most important benefits at least initially.

J&J Ottava

- While J&J's receipt of FDA approval for Ottava was widely expected, this morning's timing was ahead of expectations (as evidenced by the fact that J&J did not come to SRS prepared to showcase the system to surgeon attendees).
- Management pointed out that the de novo pathway to FDA approval (vs 510k) is noteworthy in terms of demonstrating the technology differentiation and simply not having a predicate necessary for the latter pathway.
- One key differentiator of Ottava that will clearly be central to the "sales pitch" is the significantly smaller footprint, taking up 30-50% less space in the OR – which will surely be a competitive advantage particularly in the ASC channel.
- Initial FDA clearance includes a handful of general surgery procedures, with management noting that a steady cadence of additional indication approvals across other key specialties like urology and gynecology (and additional general surgery approvals like hernia) should follow in fairly short order.
- Along with these additional indication approvals, J&J's pipeline will yield a steady output of new offerings ranging from digital, instrumentation, software, and beyond.
- In terms of commercial strategy, like Intuitive, J&J plans to offer flexible Ottava acquisition models, ranging from outright capex purchases to operating leases to per-click installations.
- Notably, unlike Medtronic (and the typical medtech playbook in general), J&J made a deliberate strategic decision to pursue US FDA approval first rather than initially targeting OUS markets with an easier/faster pathway to regulatory clearance – which management cited as a sign of confidence in the platform.
- In terms of OUS, management is next prioritizing the Japan and Western European markets, though refrained from providing estimated timelines



here.

- While the company acknowledges the market dominance of da Vinci as it enters the soft tissue robotic surgery market decades later than Intuitive, confidence remains high that Ottava represents a major growth vector for JNJ longer term given Ethicon's strong incumbent presence in MIS and the fact that global TAM penetration is still single-digits – hence the focus should remain more on market growth vs market share.

Intuitive da Vinci

- To preface, this panel discussion was pre-recorded a couple days prior to last week's 2Q results and hence the discussion did not hit on the sequential US volume slowdown nor management's reaction to this morning's approval of Ottava.
- Management is increasingly focused on the ASC channel given the continued shift of lower acuity soft tissue surgeries to this site of care. While the current da Vinci business mix (both installed base and procedures) in the ASC segment is currently single digits, the company noted that ~70% of all US ASCs are aligned with IDNs that already have da Vinci systems in the hospital setting – and as such is working collaboratively with these customers as they reallocate the lower acuity cases to the surgery center and thus freeing up more capacity for more complex surgeries to be done in the acute hospital. As more hospitals upgrade to dV5, uptake of XiR in the ASC channel has been quite good given XiR's lower price point and the much greater cost sensitivity of ASCs.
- Launch of EUP round two in 2027 is expected to yield higher technology adoption by lowering the per-procedure I&A expense specifically for high-volume, lower acuity surgeries, though we strongly suspect this was in part also a defensive strategic move given the intensifying competition from other robotic platforms as well as remanufactured instruments.
- On remanufactured instruments, the company again noted that it has thus far not seen any meaningful hit from remanufactured instrument adoption and remains largely dismissive of this threat going forward, positing that the value proposition extends beyond just instrument ASP to include reliability, safety, etc. Our checks continue to indicate a much greater risk to the I&A segment relative to the company's stance.
- As discussed below, Stryker's CEO again noted today that they are watching this remanufactured da Vinci instrument space with high interest.
- As evidenced by last week's disclosure that a GI robot is in late-stage development, Intuitive has increased its investments in new platforms in pursuit of adjacent opportunities – with the "quintuple aim" remaining foundational to the investment strategy. No additional detail was disclosed on the GI platform relative to timelines etc.
- In terms of capital deployment, organic investment remains the top priority (particularly on R&D), though external opportunities will continue to be evaluated in a focused and disciplined manner.

Stryker

- CEO Kevin Lobo, whose then-controversial venture into Mako in 2013 has, and continues to, pay off in spades as adoption of robotic-assisted recon surgery continues to increase and expand into new categories.
- While Mako now accounts for 70% of US and 50% of Stryker's global knee recon procedures, confidence is high that there still remains ample runway for continued growth/share gains in both the US and especially



internationally. Ditto for Mako hip where penetration is still considerably lower and where uptake of revisions is seeing increasing momentum. Mako revision knee remains a work in progress, and while confidence here is high, no timelines were provided.

- With Stryker's OUS sales mix remaining well below large cap medtech peers, this remains a top area of focus/investment and momentum in key businesses continues to build. While large markets like Japan, India, Germany, France and Canada have lagged in their adoption of Mako for various reasons, momentum in all is now building. For instance, in India, following significant implant price cuts in 2018, Stryker opted to deemphasize this market – but with economics here (both on the implant and Mako system sides) having improved, management noted that this is now one of the highest growth geographies for the recon franchise.
- Launch of the handheld Mako RPS robotic system continues to be very well received and which management expects to help sustain the share gain momentum in knee implants. Indeed, the company noted that a majority of early unit placements have been at competitive accounts. Stryker has not seen, nor expects to see, any cannibalization of Mako by the RPS launch.
- Rollout of Mako 4 continues to gain momentum, with management remaining bullish on the shoulder recon opportunity where expectations remain for Mako to yield market expansion given the highly challenging nature of the conventional approach that has limited the number of orthopedic surgeons doing the procedure. Mako should drive higher treatment rates.
- On soft tissue surgery, this remains an area of high interest and potential M&A opportunities continue to be evaluated, with management again noting that entry into this space would surely be via acquisition. He pointed out that, unlike J&J and Medtronic whose entry into this category was largely defensive given their strong incumbent presence in laparoscopic devices, such a move by Stryker would be purely offensive and hence will continue to be disciplined on this front.
- When asked about remanufactured da Vinci instruments, management once again confirmed that it is watching this space with high interest – and any such move here by Stryker would obviously have big implications for Intuitive.
- In terms of other robotic opportunities, management noted that robotic stroke intervention technologies are of high interest – and here too any such move here would be via acquisition vs organic R&D investment. Broadly speaking, stroke continues to be an increasing area of focus at SRS this year by other development-stage companies.

Medtronic Hugo

- While disclosures around Hugo adoption (installed base etc) continue to be frustratingly limited, directional commentary from management continues to be positive – particularly internationally where the system has now been approved/launched for some time and has broader clearances.
- While US approval is still limited to urology, clearances for general surgery and gynecology are in pursuit and once in hand will allow Hugo to address ~80% of the soft tissue robotic surgery market – and thus compel more hospitals/ASCs to evaluate the Medtronic platform.
- Management spun today's approval of J&J's Ottava as a positive for the overall robotic surgery market, arguing that technology penetration remains much more important than market share – also noting that global TAM penetration is still just single digits.



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- Medtronic's marketing pitch centers around five main differentiating attributes of Hugo: (1) modularity (enables flexibility in the OR relative to port placement etc.); (2) open visualization console that better facilitates collaboration in the OR vs the immersive da Vinci console; (3) advanced instrumentation like Ligasure that has been used in over 35 million procedures; (4) digital surgery (Touch Surgery ecosystem now in over 1500 ORs); (5) partnership model with customers.



Appendix 1

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Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
Intuitive Surgical	ISRG.OQ	340.69 (USD) 22 Jul 2026	2, 14, 24

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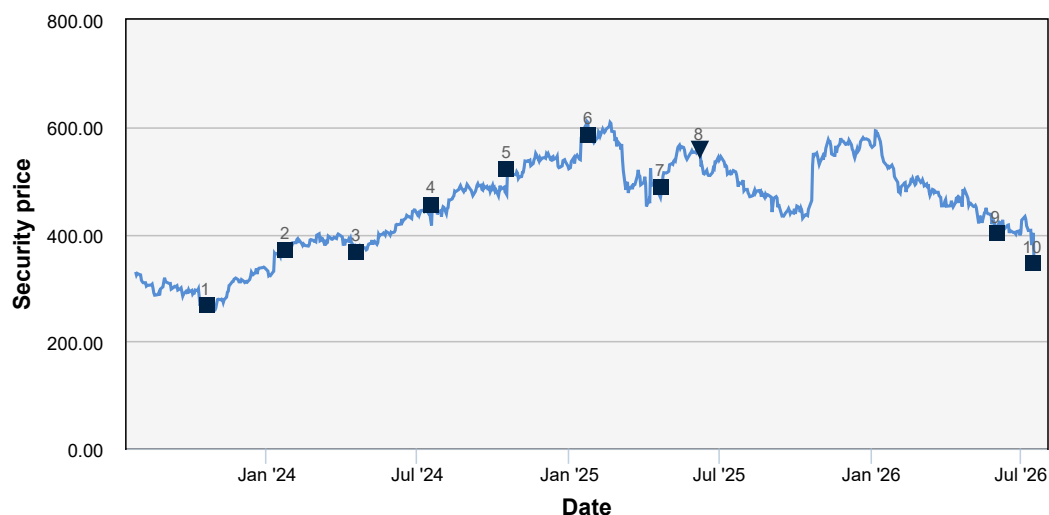
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(as of 07/22/2026)



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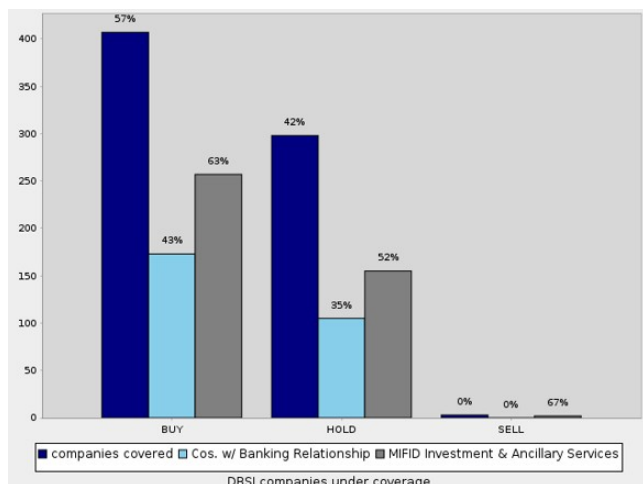
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